

VENTURA COUNTY, CA · 34°16′N 119°14′W

California Fractional HR

COMPLIANCE-FIRST · STATEWIDE

The CHRO Project — *Overview*

Senior, compliance-first HR leadership for companies of 20 to 100 employees — the judgment of a Chief HR Officer, without the full-time hire.

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THE CHRO PROJECT — OVERVIEW

Contents

CHRO-level work scoped to one destination — the offer, the file a buyer reviews, what a project builds, and where it sits on the course. Four pages, in order.

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Name the destination—
we scope the work around it.

Whatever your destination — growth, a second location, succession, or a sale — CHRO-level guidance on org design, people strategy, and leadership, so you arrive with a company worth what you've built.

FOUR DESTINATIONS · ONE PROJECT EACH

Pick where you're headed — each project is scoped to one outcome

SCALING THE TEAM
Growth
→ org design, leveling, the next key hires

OPENING A NEW SITE
A second location
→ staffing plan, site managers, your systems

THE NEXT LEADERS
Succession
→ key roles named, a successor plan drafted

FINANCING OR EXIT
A sale
→ your file organized for a buyer's review

Four common destinations, not a menu. Each project's outcome, deliverables, and milestones are set in its own SOW.

The CHRO Project

Fixed fee scoped up front

CHRO-level work scoped to one defined outcome, for a fee fixed at signing. Runs alongside your CHRO Retainer, or stands on its own.

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HOW IT'S SCOPED

- → One defined outcome, agreed in writing
- → Every deliverable listed in your Statement of Work (SOW)
- → Milestones counted from Project Start
- → One fixed fee, set for your project at signing

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Name your destination.

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What a buyer will ask— *and the file that answers.*

Every destination on page three ends with someone reviewing your people practices: a lender, a buyer, a successor. Your Reasonable Steps File is the record you can show them.

WHY A FILE, NOT A SCRAMBLE

When a buyer's questions arrive, the answers either exist in writing or get assembled under a deadline. The file is the written version: dated entries showing what was found, what was closed, and what was kept current. It is a record of fact, not a guarantee of any outcome. We advise and draft; you decide.

THE REVIEW

WHAT A BUYER ASKS · PEOPLE PRACTICES

ORG & ROLES	Who works here, in which roles, reporting to whom?
PAY	How is pay set, and are the ranges written down and applied the same way?
PRACTICES	Are the written policies followed, and is there a dated record of the steps taken?
KEY PEOPLE	Who holds the knowledge, and what happens if they leave?

THE FILE

FOUR STAGES · ONE RECORD

OPENED	The audit's findings, ranked, and the first entries in your Reasonable Steps File.
COMPLETED	Every finding you close becomes a dated, documented entry.
KEPT CURRENT	Calendar upkeep, law changes monitored, and the Exposure Map refreshed each quarter with written status.
BUYER-READY	The file organized for a buyer's review, as scoped in a CHRO Project SOW.

THE GOOD NEWS

← SEE PAGE 3

Arrival is the file's last stage.

A CHRO Project organizes your Reasonable Steps File for a buyer's review, alongside the people work your destination calls for. No file yet? The project's outcome is set in its SOW.

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ONE OUTCOME · SCOPED UP FRONT

What a CHRO Project builds — and how *each one is scoped.*

Every project starts from where you're headed. We agree on one outcome, list the deliverables, and set the fee at signing. We advise and draft; you decide.

WHAT A PROJECT CAN BUILD

01 · GROWTH

Org Blueprint

Levels, spans and layers, and the roles you'll hire next — a structure you can grow into.

02 · GROWTH

Executive Scoreboard

A short set of people numbers, each tied to a decision — labor cost, turnover, time to fill.

03 · A SECOND LOCATION

The Site Plan

The people side of a new site — staffing plan, managers, and your systems carried over, with local requirements flagged up front.

04 · SUCCESSION

Succession Plan

Key roles and key-person risk named, successor candidates named with you, and a development plan drafted for each.

05 · SUCCESSION

Leadership Bench

Coaching and development for the people you're preparing to step up.

06 · A SALE

Deal Room

The HR workstream for a financing, sale, or acquisition — org charts, pay, policies, and people records organized for a buyer's review.

Examples, not a menu. Each project's deliverables are listed in its own SOW.

WHAT YOU WALK AWAY WITH

- **The Leveled Organization**
  Roles, spans, layers, and key-person risk — named, justified, and owned.
- **A Plan for the Destination**
  The people side of growth, a new site, succession, or a sale — written down with you.
- **One Outcome, Scoped in Writing**
  The outcome, deliverables, and milestones agreed before the work starts.
- **A Buyer-Ready File**
  Your Reasonable Steps File, organized for the questions a buyer will ask.

THE CEO'S QUESTIONS
EACH ONE MET BY A PROJECT

"Is our structure ready to grow?"
→ GROWTH · ORG BLUEPRINT

"Who runs the new site?"
→ SECOND LOCATION · SITE PLAN

"Who steps up if they leave?"
→ SUCCESSION · SUCCESSION PLAN

"What will a buyer ask?"
→ A SALE · DEAL ROOM & YOUR FILE

TWO WAYS TO ENGAGE A PROJECT

Where you're headed decides the shape; the terms are the same either way.

OPTION A

Alongside your retainer

When the work outgrows the retainer's hours, by size, by deadline, or both, it becomes its own project alongside Closing the Audit or Build Systems.

WITH YOUR CHRO RETAINER · FIXED FEE

OPTION B · STANDALONE

On its own

Growth, a second location, succession, or a sale — scoped as one project, with no retainer required.

CHRO PROJECT · FIXED FEE · SET AT SIGNING

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→ *one destination — one outcome — one fixed fee.*

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Reach your destination— *with the file to show for it.*

Four cards, one course — get your bearings, correct your course, increase your speed, reach your destination. The thread through all four is your Reasonable Steps File: opened, completed, kept current, made buyer-ready.

CLEARING THE HAZARDS

01 ASSESS
Get your bearings
Opening the Audit · Opens your file

02 REPAIR
Correct your course
Closing the Audit · Completes your file

OPEN WATER

03 RUN
Increase your speed
Build Systems · Keeps your file current

04 ARRIVE
Reach your destination
Custom Projects · Makes your file buyer-ready

CARD 04 — ARRIVE — IS CUSTOM PROJECTS

WHAT YOU'RE ACTUALLY BUYING

A buyer will review your people practices. A well-maintained and complete Reasonable Steps File answers their questions before they're asked. It's the difference between assembling answers under a deadline and opening a file you've kept all along.

— **You choose the destination.**
Growth, a second location, succession, or a sale — one outcome, scoped in writing.

— **The price is set before the work starts.**
One fixed fee at signing; deliverables listed in your SOW, milestones counted from Project Start.

— **Your file is organized before the ask.**
Financing, a sale, or succession — your people records organized for a buyer's review.

REACH YOUR DESTINATION

Arrive with what you've built.

You built the company one decision at a time. When you're ready for what's next — growth, a second location, succession, or a sale — a CHRO Project scopes the people side to one outcome, and your Reasonable Steps File shows the steps you've taken. You decide; we advise and draft.

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